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Ahmad Alotbi/Gulf News

TENS OF THOUSANDS FLOCK TO GLOBAL VILLAGE

Dubai's Global Village has become a must-visit destination, attracting millions every year. It's a celebration of diversity, culture, and entertainment and remains one of Dubai's most anticipated events year after year. Tens of thousands flocked yesterday, reportedly the final day before its closure for summer, to explore 90 pavilions offering a vibrant mix of food, shopping, entertainment and cultural experiences. **FOR UPDATES, GO TO GULFNEWS.COM**

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NATION

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PROPERTY

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Trump offers incentives to India and Pakistan

PROPOSAL TO INCREASE TRADE COMES AFTER TRUCE DEAL

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump said yesterday he would increase trade "substantially" with India and Pakistan, following the "full and immediate" halt to hostilities unexpectedly announced by him on social media earlier.

"I am going to increase trade, substantially, with both of these great nations," he posted on TruthSocial after the neighbours agreed to a ceasefire.

He said the ceasefire followed a "long night of talks mediated by the United States". Trump later praised the leaders of India and Pakistan for understanding that "it was time to stop the current aggression".

Earlier, Shaikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, held phone calls with Dr Subrahmanyam Jaishankar, Minister of External Affairs of India, and Muhammad Ishaq Dar, Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister of Pakistan. During the calls, Shaikh Abdullah commended the wisdom of both sides in agreeing to a ceasefire, which he said would benefit both countries, their peoples, and the South Asia region as a whole. Shaikh Abdullah expressed his hope that this step would contribute to enhancing security and stability in the region.

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Beijing's backing

Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi said that Beijing supported India and Pakistan's efforts to reach a ceasefire, and remains "willing to continue playing a constructive role" in the process, state news agency Xinhua reported.

United Nations Secretary General Antonio Guterres also welcomed the ceasefire, hoping that it will be implemented, his spokesperson Farhan Haq said on Saturday. "We welcome all efforts at de-escalation and hope that the ceasefire will be implemented", Haq said, adding, "We are monitoring" the situation.

UK Foreign Secretary David Lammy praised the ceasefire agreement, calling it "hugely welcome." He urged both nations to maintain the truce, emphasising that de-escalation is in everyone's best interest, in a post on X.

Similarly, the EU's High Representative for Foreign Affairs, Kaja Kallas, described the ceasefire as a "vital step toward de-escalation," stressing the need for all efforts to ensure its adherence.

The ceasefire appeared to hold yesterday after Pakistan fully reopened its airspace to all types of flights. In a statement issued, the Pakistan Airport Authority (PAA) confirmed the full restoration of airspace nationwide and released an updated Notice to Airmen (NOTAM). Many UAE carriers have also resumed flight operations to Pakistan and India. UAE airlines Emirates, Etihad, and Air Arabia announced early yesterday, the partial service resumption of flights to Pakistan, subject to the "ongoing situation" in the South Asian country.

— Agencies

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